occurred on the banks of Aras River[6] in Turkistan against the Aūzbegs. The latter had attacked while returning from a raid near Samarkand. This battle is worth remembering for many reasons: Umar crossed the river while ice floated upon it. He gave the Aūzbegs a good bashing. Babur praised his father for this battle. He has said that Umar distributed the booty among the owners without keeping even a bit for himself.

Umar was beaten in the third major battle that he fought with Babur's uncle Sulṭān Ahmad Mīrzā at Khwas, a place between Shahrukhiya and Aūrā-tīpā.

As mentioned earlier, Abu Sa'id had given Umar Shaikh the land of Ferghana. Sulṭān Ahmad Mīrzā, Umar's elder brother had granted him Tashkent and Sairam. All three stayed in his possession for quite some time. Umar Shaikh had even taken away Shahrukhiya by a timid trick and had held it for a while. It was not very late when Tashkent and Shahrukhiya slipped out of his hands. He was only left with Ferghana, parts of Khujand and Aūrā-tīpā. Sulṭān Ahmad Mīrzā lost Tashkent to Moghūls in the battle fought at the banks of Chirciq River in AD 1488.

Sulṭān Mahmud Khān of Moghūlistan and Sulṭān Ahmed Mīrzā, the Tīmūrid ruler of Samarkand and Bukhara were involved in this conflict. The Tīmūrids had to taste the defeat at the hands of Moghūls. One of the prime reasons for this defeat was the defection of 3000 Aūzbegs under the command of Muhammad Shaybāni Khān.[*]

Sulṭān Mahmud Khān reached the banks of Chirciq River, crossing the suburbs of Tashkent. On the opposite edge stood the Tīmūrid Army of Sulṭān Ahmad Mīrzā. Initially, it appeared as if it was impossible to cross the river Chirciq and both armies camped on the opposite banks for three days. Mīrzā's army had Muhammad Shaybāni Khān, the son of Shah Budagh Oghlan, the son of Abul-Khayr Khān ibn Dawlat Shaykh ibn Ibrahim Khān. Muhammad Shaybāni Khān was unable to hold his own in the steppes, so he betook himself to Transoxiana and became a retainer of one of Sulṭān Ahmed Mīrzā's Amirs named Mir Abdul Ali. Shaybāni Khān was in control of 3000 men. During the halt of three days, devilish thoughts had engulfed Shaybāni's mind. He sent a message to Sulṭān Mahmud Khān, asking if he would meet and confer with him. They met as soon as the darkness kissed the surroundings. An understanding cooked between the two and it was decided that the next day, Mahmud would attack Mir Abdul Ali, the master of Muhammad Shaybāni